

Vanessa Bell

Design Engineer · Product Designer

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vanessabell.design

in/vanessajoanbell

Skills

Design:

- Heuristic Evaluation
- User Research
- Figma
- Interaction Design
- Information Architecture
- Design Systems

Engineering:

- React
- TypeScript
- React Native
- WordPress
- Claude Code

Education

CoCreate (2025)

UX Design Externship

Coursera (2025)

Google UX Design Certificate

Designlab (2024)

Web & UI Design Certificate

Coding Dojo (2016)

Full Stack Web Dev

Santa Clara University (2014)

B.A. Sociology, Minors in

International Business &

Spanish

Design engineer and product designer with a software engineering foundation (React, TypeScript). I design and implement, moving from user research and Figma to shipped production code without a handoff gap.

Experience

Design Engineer (Contract)

Forma Health | Remote

March – May 2026

Sole designer responsible for research, design, and frontend implementation of a rare disease study configuration portal built in Angular/TypeScript.

- Ran three rounds of heuristic evaluation directly in the codebase, identifying action hierarchy failures and missing accuracy indications.
- Observed a practicing physician struggle with the interface in context; identified a mental model inversion that became the brief for a full workflow rebuild
- Rebuilt the review experience around an AI-first model: LLM auto-runs on utterance creation, read-only by default, contextual CTAs
- Designed field noise reduction pattern adopted by the engineering team for the patient-facing mobile application
- Delivered 9x reduction in time and steps for a workflow researchers repeat dozens of times

UX Lead - Research & Concept Validation

Sept - Oct 2025

SpendLight | Remote

Led generative research to understand why users abandon budgeting tools. Designed and iterated mid- and high-fidelity prototypes in Figma; moderated usability tests; validated a journaling-based MVP aligned with user emotion and founder goals.

UX Designer & Researcher (CoCreate Cohort)

Jun - Aug 2025

Talofa Games | Remote

Designed and moderated unmoderated and 1:1 usability studies for a mobile fitness game. Synthesized research into design changes shifting focus toward emotional engagement within existing technical constraints.

UX Designer & Web Developer (Contract)

Mar 2025 - Present

Purusha Yoga & Pilates Studio | Remote

Designed and implemented key website pages in WordPress. Ongoing content, performance, and design updates.

Senior Software Engineer — Multiple Companies

2017-2023

San Francisco, CA

Built and shipped user-facing web and mobile products using React, React Native, and TypeScript. Partnered with product and design teams, often bridging gaps between user needs and technical implementation.